

The Brook

Q.1. Who is “I” referred to in the poem?

The “I” in the poem refers to the brook itself. The poet has personified the brook and it narrates its own journey.

Q.2. Trace the journey of the brook.

The brook starts from a place in the hills that is a haunt of birds like coots and herons. It flows down valleys and hills, towns, farms, and meadows. Along the way, it moves through curves and turns, over pebbles and stones, sometimes swiftly and sometimes gently. It passes through places with thorny bushes, blooming flowers, and aquatic plants before finally joining the brimming river.

Q.3. Explain the following lines:

“For men may come and men may go,
But I go on for ever.”

These lines highlight the contrast between human life and nature. Human beings are mortal and temporary—they are born and die. But the brook (symbolizing nature) continues to flow endlessly. This shows the eternal nature of natural elements as compared to the short span of human life.

Q.4. Alliteration is the repetition of initial consonant sounds in verse such as, “I slip, I slide, I gloom, I glance”. Pick out more examples of alliteration from the poem.

Here are more examples of alliteration from the poem:

“Sudden sally”

“Field and fallow”

“Bubble, babble”

“I murmur under moon and stars”

Q.5. Can the journey of the brook be compared to human life? How?

Yes, the journey of the brook can be compared to human life.

In the beginning, the brook is lively and energetic, just like childhood and youth.

As it moves on, it becomes more calm and steady, similar to middle age.

Finally, it merges into the river, just as a human life ends in death or eternity.

This comparison shows that the brook symbolizes the different stages of human life—from birth to death.